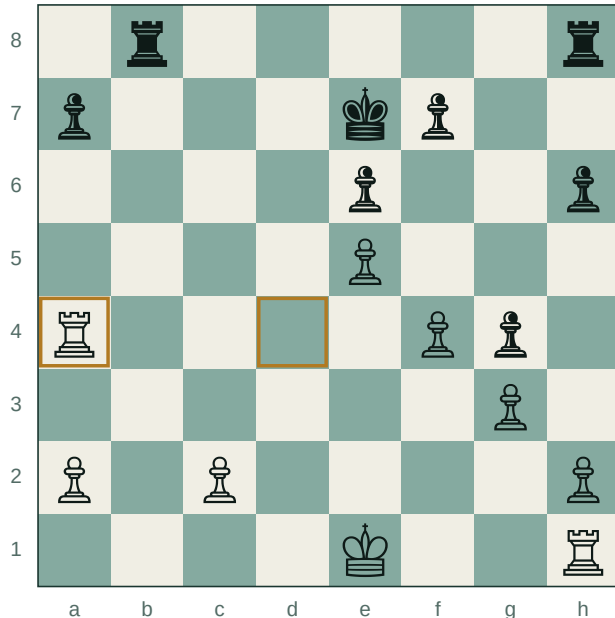


Active defensive resources: Black, move 25

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Ra4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Rb1+ 26. Kf2 Rxb1 27. Rxa7+ Kf8

25...Rb1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **26.Kf2**.

26...Rxb1 The rook captures the rook on h1. Recorded reply: **27.Rxa7+**.

27...Kf8 The king moves from e7 to f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a4 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.